PRACTICE 02 · 10-MINUTE

The Pressure *Practice*

Pressure → **Self-Assurance**

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	*Any time*	*Beginner*	*4*

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Pressure is the feeling that something needs to be done, and done right, right now. It's the internal push to perform, decide, deliver, or hold things together. Often without anyone asking out loud.

Pressure isn't always about workload. It's about the standards you're trying to meet. The tight jaw. The shallow breath. The sense that slowing down would mean falling behind. This practice is here to help you step out of urgency and remember that care doesn't require pressure.

> ***"Everything is happening as it should be."***

A note before you begin.

This practiceonly workswhen you actually do it, not when you read about it. The shift happens in your body, not in your head. Trust what you feel during it, even if it surprises you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- A steady object nearby
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

Optional: Lavender (softens urgency), Bergamot (eases perfectionism), Frankincense (grounding), or Clary Sage (supports release). Choose one.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Pressure often comes from internal rules. Unspoken standards about how quickly something needs to happen or how much of yourself it requires. This practice names the rule underneath the pressure, then softens the body's response to it.

1	Thought Work	*4 min*
2	Grounding Breath	*3 min*
3	Micro-Release	*2 min*
4	Close	*1 min*

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

7 MINUTES

Pressure is a feeling, and feelings are created by thoughts. Something happens, your brain generates a thought about it ('I must get this right, or else'), that thought creates a physical feeling, that feeling drives your behaviour. Most of the time this chain runs completely on autopilot.

What mindfulness gives us is the pause between the stimulus and the response. In it, we can see the thought that's creating the pressure, question it a little, and find something slightly more workable to think instead. Less pressure doesn't make you less motivated. It usually makes you sharper.

1. BREATHE IN

Take three slow breaths. Each time you exhale, consciously release your jaw. Let your shoulders drop. Unclench your hands if they're tight.

Pressure keeps the body braced. The exhale shifts that. It moves you from automatic to aware, from braced to open.

2. FIND IT IN YOUR BODY

Without trying to change anything yet, notice: Where am I feeling pressure right now?

Tight chest? Tension across the shoulders or in your jaw? A hollow, knotted stomach? A sense of bracing, like you're waiting for something to go wrong? Approach it with curiosity rather than judgment.

3. WRITE YOUR THOUGHTS

Set a timer for 60-90 seconds. Let your brain say everything it believes about this situation. What's at stake, what needs to happen, what will go wrong if it doesn't.

4. FIND A THOUGHT YOU CAN BELIEVE

Find the thought creating the most pressure. Now find a version that's just slightly less contracted.

Some options to try:

"I can focus on doing my best, not on controlling how this turns out."

"My worth isn't on the line here."

"Pressure is telling me I care. I can care without bracing."

"I am more capable than this feeling is telling me right now."

02 Grounding Breath

3 MINUTES

Pressure tightens the upper body. The shoulders brace. The jaw holds. Breathing slowly and fully sends a direct signal to the nervous system that the threat has passed. You don't need to calm down. Just let the pace change.

1. THE BREATH

Sit or stand comfortably. Inhale slowly through the nose, feeling the breath move into the ribs. Exhale through the mouth, longer than the inhale.

Repeat for several rounds. Let the shoulders drop. Let the jaw soften.

Nature does not hurry, yet everything is accomplished.

03 Micro-Release

2 MINUTES

Pressure often lives in small, held places. This step releases it with simple, deliberate movement. Notice where effort can be reduced without stopping entirely.

1. MOVEMENT

Gently roll your shoulders. Massage your jaw or neck. Unclench your hands.

Stand up and move slowly and deliberately. Notice every step. Notice where effort can be reduced without stopping entirely.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Place one hand on your heart. If you're holding the steady object, notice its weight for a moment. Choose one statement that feels true right now.

"I can move forward without rushing."

"Care doesn't require pressure."

"I'm allowed to choose my pace."

PRACTICE COMPLETE

You don't need pressure to do meaningful work.

Today, yousteppedout of urgency,evenbriefly.Thatmatters. Clarityoftenarriveswhenspeeddrops. Return to this practice whenever perfectionism starts tightening your body.

Creating inner balance, one conscious pause at a time.

CONTINUE THE WORK

The Full Library. All five Practices for $57.

Overwhelm isone layer.Pressure,self-doubt,uncertainty,andguilt are the others. The Full Library gives you a structured practice for each one.

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